2.3.1. Essentials

Some operators come from JavaScript with only minor changes and, in some cases, aliases. The operator precedence rules are unchanged from JavaScript.

Assignment

This operator is provided by the `=` symbol. Use it when you need to assign a value to a name:

```
wuss = 'A weak or ineffectual person'
chuckNorris = 'Chuck Norris'
```

CoffeeScript doesn't let you accidentally declare global variable names—you don't want global variables.

Negation

This operator is provided by `!` or the alias `not`. Use it to get `true` or `false` depending on whether the value is truthy or falsy:

```
!true
# false
```

Falsy values

The values `null`, `false`, `''`, `undefined`, and `0` are called *falsy* values in CoffeeScript because they have the value `false` when coerced to a boolean, such as when used in an `if` clause. All other values in CoffeeScript will have the value `true`, making them *truthy*. You can observe this on the REPL by evaluating each of them prefixed with `!!`, such as `!!''`, which will give you `false`.

Equality and inequality

These operators are provided by `==`, `!=`, or the aliases `is` and `isnt`, respectively. Use them to determine whether two values are equal or not: